

4.5 The Refinement Loop

4.5.1 The Refinement Loop Protocol

Most matrices require two to three iteration cycles before the voice stabilizes. Follow this sequence for each cycle.

Cycle [1 / 2 / 3]:

- 1. **Generate.** Paste your current matrix into the AI tool. Generate one stress-test scene (whichever drifted last).
- 2. **Verify.** Run the Ninety-Second Voice Verification Read. Note which dimensions hold and which drift.
- 3. **Identify.** Name the single field most responsible for the drift. Write it down.
- 4. **Adjust.** Change that one field. Add one constraint, tighten one boundary, or replace one vague phrase with a specific parameter.
- 5. **Regenerate.** Run the same scene again with the updated matrix.
- 6. **Confirm.** Reverify. Did the drift resolve? If yes, move to the next drifting field. If no, sharpen the constraint further and regenerate once more.
- 7. **Log.** Record the result in the Iteration Tracker below.

Key discipline: Adjust one field at a time. If you change three fields simultaneously and the output shifts, you cannot identify which change caused the improvement.

4.5.2 Iteration Tracker

Character: [CHARACTER_NAME]

Matrix Version: [V1.0 / V1.1 / V1.2]

Date: [DATE]

Cycle #	Scene Tested	Drifting Field	Adjustment Made	Result	Next Action
1	[Conflict / Flirtation / Vulnerability]	[E.G., Emotional Default]	[E.G., "Added wound-specific trigger clause"]	[Held / Improved / Worsened]	[E.G., "Move to Cadence Signature"]
2	[SCENE]	[FIELD]	[ADJUSTMENT]	[RESULT]	[NEXT_ACTION]
3	[SCENE]	[FIELD]	[ADJUSTMENT]	[RESULT]	[NEXT_ACTION]

If any row reads "Worsened," revert the adjustment immediately. Return to the previous version of that field. Try a different, more specific constraint.

4.5.3 Decision Tree: Am I Done Iterating?

Question 1: Have you completed at least two full rounds of iteration?

- **No** → Keep iterating, because you are still in the normal range for this process.
- **Yes** → Move on to Question 2.

Question 2: Does the voice stay consistent across all three stress-test scenes: conflict, flirtation, and vulnerability?

- **No** → Find the scene where the voice drifts. Adjust the field responsible for that drift. Regenerate the output. Verify the voice again.
- **Yes** → Move on to Question 3.

Question 3: Have you already completed three or more rounds?

- **No** → Your matrix is finished. Save it, label it, and move forward.
- **Yes** → Stop here. Your matrix is finished. More tweaking will give you smaller and smaller improvements. Save it, label it, and move forward. You can refine it later in Chapter 8.